

1. AI enthusiasts are in a race against time, AI skeptics are in a race against entropy

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-04T23:55:27+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/4/ai-enthusiasts-ai-skeptics/#atom-everything>

AI enthusiasts are in a race against time, AI skeptics are in a race against entropy Charity Majors neatly captures the dynamic between AI enthusiasts and AI skeptics, both of whom are trying to build great software, often in the same teams: The enthusiasts are not wrong . We are starting to see real, non-imaginary, discontinuous leaps in capabilities from teams that lean in hard to working with AI. And this does not feel like a normal technology cycle where you can wait for the dust to settle; teams that sit this out while competitors are hustling could be out of business before the dust settles. That's a real, existential threat. The skeptics are also not wrong . When you ship code faster than engineers can read it, in domains where nobody has full context, you are making withdrawals from a trust account that took years to build. Reliability degrades, institutional knowledge evaporates. You end up with systems nobody understands, products burbling into incoherence, and on-call rotations that grind people up and spit them out. That is ALSO a real existential threat. Charity recommends treating this as both a leadership challenge and an engineering challenge. The key issue: There...

2. Quoting Emanuel Maiberg, 404 Media

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-04T16:38:29+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/4/a-slightly-different-version/#atom-everything>

After this story was published Google's spokesperson reached out and asked us to publish a slightly different version of that statement. The new statement no longer stated that "it's critical that we maintain humans in the loop." ? Emanuel Maiberg, 404 Media , Google Employees Internally Share Memes About How Its AI Sucks Tags: ai-ethics , journalism , ai , google

3. micropython-wasm 0.1a0

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-02T03:43:45+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/2/micropython-wasm-2/#atom-everything>

Release: micropython-wasm 0.1a0 My latest sandboxing experiment: This alpha package bundles a lightly customized WASM build of MicroPython with a wrapper to execute code in it via wasmtime . Tags: python , sandboxing , webassembly

4. Some People Rooted for The Empire in 'Star Wars', Too

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-05T00:43:33Z

Link: <https://hotair.com/ed-morrissey/2026/06/03/cbs-fires-scott-pelley-after-trying-very-hard-to-get-fired-n3815553>

Ed Morrissey, writing for Hot Air, thinks Scott Pelley got what he deserved and Bari Weiss is doing a good job running CBS News: And Pelley forgot the Golden Rule: He who has the gold makes the rules . Instead, Pelley convinced himself of his own virtue and torched his own position ? and if Bilton's letter is accurate, in as mean-spirited and conceited a manner as possible. Pelley could have chosen a dignified resignation under protest, but instead pulled a power move in an attempt to intimidate Bilton, Weiss, and Ellison, only to discover that no one feared his absence. In fact, they're probably happy to cut him loose. There's always at least one person in these situations who thinks they're untouchable. A wise executive knows to start by making an example of that person, and then see how many other people think they're indispensable. It's not as if TV news jobs are expanding these days, after all. Pelley's going to find out the hard way that no one's paying \$5 million a year to emot into a camera from other people's copy. It doesn't even enter this man's little mind that Pelley wasn't concerned about his job, wasn't concerned about his salary, but was concerned only with the in...

5. The Talk Show Live From WWDC 2026: Tuesday in San Jose

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-04T22:05:05Z

Link: <https://ti.to/daringfireball/the-talk-show-live-from-wwdc-2026>

Location: The California Theatre, San Jose Showtime: Tuesday, 9 June 2026, 7pm PT (Doors open 6pm) Special Guest(s): For sure Price: \$45 The annual live audience episode of The Talk Show during the week of WWDC. If you can make it, you should come. You'll even enjoy the prelude, mingling with fellow DF readers and listeners. ?

6. ?The Insider?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-04T20:42:35Z

Link: <https://letterboxd.com/film/the-insider/>

All this Sturm und Drang surrounding 60 Minutes has me thinking about a re-watch of The Insider , Michael Mann's great 1999 movie. Letterboxd's synopsis: ?A research chemist comes under personal and professional attack when he decides to appear in a 60 Minutes expos  on Big Tobacco.? It's a great movie, and feels apt AF at the moment. Here's the original segment on 60 Minutes , which ran an entire half hour. What's going on today is like if ? instead of getting shady, threatening, and litigious ? the tobacco companies had just purchased CBS, purged the staff at 60 Minutes, and hired a bunch of pro-cigarette stooges to replace them. ?

7. Anti-AI nostalgia and the cult of the past

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/anti-ai-nostalgia/>

Programmers were better back in the day, weren't they? Back when we had real programmers. Not just people who got paid to write code, but people who lived it, who were obsessed with their craft, and whose code was a lively expression of themselves. Hackers were hackers in those days before money took over the industry. Don't even get me started on LLMs. Could there be a better example of today's degenerate spirit? A machine to mass-produce software (not good software, just barely good enough), so that the weak minds that dominate the industry can indulge their obsession with quantity : of slop code, of features, and ultimately of money, which is the only way they can understand value. If they weren't destroying our way of life, they would be pitiable. All of them together don't have a fraction of the spiritual integrity of someone like Mel . But as it is, we must band together to crush them and drive them from our industry like the parasites they are. Returning to the past Okay, that's not actually what I believe. But there sure are a lot of posts 1 and comments on the internet that sound a bit like the paragraph above. Here are some older quotes that might sound similar: ?the thi...

8. Rotation revisited: A shocking discovery about gcc's unidirectional rotation algorithm

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 03 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260603-00/?p=112378>

We've seen this before. The post Rotation revisited: A shocking discovery about gcc's unidirectional rotation algorithm appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. The Latin of Linux

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 20:12:11 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/04/the-latin-of-linux/>

One reason people study Latin is that it is the ancestor of many modern languages. English derives from West Germanic languages, not from Latin, but much of English vocabulary, perhaps as much as 60%, derives from Latin, either directly or indirectly through French. Knowing a bit of Latin makes sense of many things that would [?] The post The Latin of Linux first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Integrating smooth periodic functions

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 17:18:40 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/04/integrating-smooth-periodic-functions/>

Several posts lately have looked at the function $f(x) = \cos(\sin(x) + x)$. This post will look at the function from a different angle. It's a smooth function with period 2π , and it's very flat at odd multiples of π , i.e. the first five derivatives are zero. For reasons I wrote about

here, this means that [?] The post Integrating smooth periodic functions first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Partitions over permutations

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 13:48:56 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/04/partitions-over-permutations/>

I was thinking more about the cosine approximation to the Gaussian $\exp(-z^2) \approx (1 + \cos(\sin(z) + z))/2$ that I wrote about last week. The two expressions above are close along the real axis but not along the imaginary axis. If $z = iy$, the right side grows much faster than the left, behaving like $\exp(\exp(y))$. This led to [?] The post Partitions over permutations first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Giving your Go apps Tigris superpowers

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Tue, 09 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://www.tigrisdata.com/blog/storage-sdk-go/>

Tigris is S3-compatible, which means you can point the AWS SDK at it and most things just work. The catch is that the Tigris-exclusive features?bucket forking, snapshots, object renaming, and the like?need verbose workarounds because the AWS SDK doesn't know they exist. So we wrote a Go SDK that does. It comes in two flavors: the storage package is a drop-in replacement for the standard S3 client with first-class methods for the Tigris-specific operations, and simplestorage is a higher-level client for the common single-bucket case that infers its configuration from the environment so you stop passing the same parameters over and over. You can adopt the Tigris features incrementally without refactoring your existing S3 code, and the simpler API still works against other S3-compatible providers. I wrote up how it works and why we built it over on the Tigris blog.

13. IPv6 zones in URLs are a mistake

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Fri, 05 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/ipv6-zones-go-url/>

Run away while you still can, it's not too late for you to avoid the curse of knowledge.

14. Book Review: Accessible Communications by Lisa Riemers and Matisse Hamel-Nelis ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 11:34:53 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/book-review-accessible-communications-by-lisa-riemers-and-matisse-hamel-nelis/>

My mate Lisa has written a book! Along with her pal Matisse, she takes us through the practicalities of publishing communications which are accessible to all. This isn't just about the theory - it takes us across multiple legal jurisdictions, ethical frameworks, and business cases. Once it is done convincing you of the necessity of the work, it begins to explain how to actually create useful?

15. London Data Store Relaunch

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 03 Jun 2026 11:34:49 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/london-data-store-relaunch/>

It has been sixteen years since the launch of data.london.gov.uk. Back then, it was a trailblazer as one of the first major cities to release Open Data in this way. Now, over a decade later, it is more than a mere repository; it is a celebration of Open Data and the way it can improve Londoners' lives. So, time for a refresh front and back. As well as a bunch of back-end updates, the front-end?

16. Using FourSquare's API to post location checkins to social media

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 02 Jun 2026 11:34:51 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/using-foursquares-api-to-post-location-checkins-to-social-media/>

What is this, 2016? I like sharing my location with my pocket friends sometimes. If I'm in a

cool bar that they know, perhaps they can recommend a drink. If they live nearby, maybe they want to come for dinner. Not everyone has FourSquare's SwarmApp, so it is handy to automatically share its updates with other people. Of course, Swarm doesn't cross-post to social media because walled-gardens?

17. "Sixteenth of a year", a 1.8 KiB art piece

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Wed, 03 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/sixteenth-of-a-year/>

As I write this, we're about 7 sixteenths through 2026, and it's about 14 sixteenths through the day. For the sixteenth issue of the Taper online magazine, I split time into sixteenths to think about its passage in a different way. The code, which had to be under 2048 bytes, isn't terribly complex. It does some date math and uses a Go server for minification. If you want, here's the unminified source code . Go check out all the other entries from this issue ! My favorites include "[SIC]" , "Desperate Measures from a Dying Regime" , and "(un)done" . See also: my previous Taper entry .

18. gittuf - a signed log for git refs

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-06-04T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/06/04/gittuf-a-signed-log-for-git-refs.html>

Commit signatures are part of git. Branch protection isn't. It's a row in a database run by the forge, checked by the forge's API before accepting a push. Most of the interesting source-repository attacks have landed in the gap between the two. What the forge enforces Branch protection, required reviews, CODEOWNERS , merge queues, status checks, required signatures: every one is administered by the forge, and none follow the repository when you clone it. A server presenting the repository can serve whatever ref pointers it likes. The rules can also be changed without any record in git. A flipped toggle in the settings page disables required reviews for the time it takes to push a commit, and re-enables it after. The only record sits in an audit log run by the same forge. In March 2021 someone pushed two commits onto the self-hosted PHP git server , into php-src, falsely attributed to Rasmus Lerdorf and Nikita Popov. The post-mortem points at the server itself, not at either developer's account. The project's response was to stop running their own git server and move canonical hosting to GitHub. Commit signing wouldn't have stopped this on its own: the commits weren't signed, and n...

19. How Long Does It Take to Plan a Bridge?

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 15:24:24 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-long-does-it-take-to-plan-a-bridge>

Many folks, including me, have observed that it seems to take much longer to build infrastructure in the US than it used to.

20. How To Read More

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/how-to-read-more>

How text can outcompete the screen.

21. Using Safetensors with Flax

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 23:30:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilestomas.com/2026/06/flax-and-safetensors>

I'm porting my PyTorch LLM code to JAX , using Flax as the neural network layer. For various reasons I wanted to use Safetensors to store checkpoints of the model. It took a little while to get it working; here's the trick I learned. If you look at the Safetensors docs, you'll see that it doesn't mention a JAX implementation -- indeed, searching for "safetensors jax" at the time I'm writing this gives you a link to this GitHub repo by Alvaro Bartolome -- which was last updated in 2023. However, if you look more closely at the docs, they do have a link to the Flax API . I feel this is somewhat misnamed, as it is actually a JAX API. There's no reference

(again, as of the time of writing) to Flax in the source -- it's all just JAX code. And in fact Bartolome's library uses it under the hood. There is one problem, though. The API works with simple single-level dictionaries, with strings mapping directly to JAX arrays. For example, the `save_file` function has this signature: `def save_file ( tensors : Dict [ str , Array ], filename : Union [ str , os . PathLike ], metadata : Optional [ Dict [ str , str ] ] = None , ) -> None`. This can cause problems if you're not careful. If you look at th...

22. Pluralistic: Delusion as a service (04 Jun 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 06:42:39 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/03/mission-space/>

Today's links Delusion as a service: Destructive diagnostics. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Gay Days at Disney World; Parametric 3D printable key; Fine against sculpture for "storing bike on public property"; TPP is a wash; Reagan was Trump; Steampunk roadster; "Every Heart a Doorway"; Shoplifters x Tumblr; Amazon v mass arbitration; Driver-owned Uber alternative; Censorware censors criticism of censorware; 3 strikes copyright termination is illegal; Replacing al Qaeda bomb recipes with cakes; \$10m grilled cheese platform; Dick van Dyke x Bernie; Efficiency is inefficient; I quit. Upcoming appearances: Kansas City, LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Edinburgh, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Delusion as a service (permalink) In 2003, Disney opened a new Epcot ride, "Mission: Space." Formally, it was a space travel sim that used a giant, high-intensity centrifuge to simulate gee stresses; practically, it turned out to be the most efficient machine ever created for surfacing previously undiagnosed heart defect...

23. Alex Imas and Phil Trammell ? What remains scarce after AGI?

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Thu, 04 Jun 2026 16:14:49 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/alex-imas-phil-trammell>

?One robot now turns into many robots next year, but the number of ballerinas is the same.?

24. Modern C++ for C programmers: part 2

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Thu, 14 Jun 2018 20:26:28 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/cpp-2/>

Welcome back! In part 1 I discussed how `std::string` and `std::vector` interoperate with C, including with the C standard library `qsort` call. We also discovered that the C++ `std::sort` is 40% faster than C `qsort` because C++ is able to inline the comparison function. In this part we continue with further C++ features that you can use to spice up your code ?line by line?, without immediately having to use all 1400 pages of ?The C++ Programming Language?.

25. Modern C++ for C Programmers: part 1

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 13 Jun 2018 21:04:19 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/c++-1/>

Welcome to part 1 of Modern C++ for C Programmers, please see the introduction for the goals and context of this series. In this part we start with C++ features that you can use to spice up your code ?line by line?, without immediately having to use all 1400 pages of ?The C++ Programming Language?. Various code samples discussed here can be found on GitHub. Relation between C and C++ C and C++ are actually very close relatives, to the point that many compilers have unified infrastructure for both languages.

26. Under-prepared Meetings

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 29 May 2018 19:13:46 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/meetings/>

Ahhh.. meetings. The one old school company thing that survives in this agile, open-office, ?remote first?, nomadic worker world. And it is easy to see why: the ?meeting? is the last guaranteed way to get everyone to pay attention for an hour, or at least, pretend to. It still

is rare for people to fake attending two meetings at the same time in any case. The late great Andrew S. Grove, long time CEO of Intel and overall hero engineer, wrote the massively important book High Output Management.